

TERMINAL-OS

One-page app summary based only on repo evidence | 2026-03-05

React | Vite | TypeScript | SCSS

WHAT IT IS

Terminal-OS is an OS-like retro UI built with React, Vite, TypeScript, and SCSS modules. It combines a landing flow, a panel-based desktop shell, and four subsystems: ME, YOU, THIRD, and CONNECT.

WHO IT IS FOR

Primary persona inferred from seeded ME desktop copy and content: portfolio visitors browsing work, media, and contact details through a desktop metaphor.

WHAT IT DOES

- Boots from ENTER.EXE into a 2x2 desktop with a persistent bottom status bar.
- Runs ME.EXE as a live mini ME.OS that expands to fullscreen without resetting state.
- Uses FileMan over a versioned virtual file system seeded with Home, Projects, Media, Archive, About, Contact, and README items.
- Opens text, image, video, project, and contact files in dedicated viewer windows.
- Provides YOU.EXE as a preview and fullscreen message board backed by an HTTP API when configured.
- Provides THIRD.EXE as a 3D scene playground with primitives, edit/play modes, physics, undo/redo, and autosave.
- Keeps dock, menu, window, and context behavior scope-aware across panel and fullscreen modes.

HOW TO RUN

- npm install
- npm run dev
- Open <http://localhost:5173>
- Optional for live YOU backend: set VITE_YOU_API_BASE_URL in .env.local

HOW IT WORKS

Compact architecture overview from repo code:

- main.tsx mounts ThemeProvider and App.
- App.tsx owns the landing sequence, preload heuristics, and lazy loading of DesktopRuntime.
- DesktopRuntime composes MeOsProvider, MeOsVfsProvider, YouProvider, ThirdProvider, and ConnectProvider, then renders Desktop, StatusBar, and fullscreen layers.
- ME data flow: Desktop and FileMan actions -> MeOsProvider window or scope state -> VFS service -> versioned localStorage snapshot -> subscribed VFS consumers rerender.
- YOU data flow: YouProvider -> YouApiClient -> GET or POST to VITE_YOU_API_BASE_URL or /api/you.
- THIRD data flow: ThirdProvider -> state and history helpers -> local persistence with autosave. CONNECT deeper backend or service layer: Not found in repo.

Evidence basis: README.md, docs/overview.md, docs/dev-quickstart.md, src/App.tsx, src/components/AppShell/DesktopRuntime.tsx, src/meos/shell/MeOsProvider.tsx, src/meos/vfs/service.ts, src/meos/vfs/seed.ts, src/you/service.ts, src/third/ThirdProvider.tsx, and subsystem entry components.